

Sausages Around the World

The Nurembergers of Germany's Franconia region may lay claim to having invented the bratwurst, but a love of grilled sausage has long since spread throughout much of the Western world. Over time, many nations have developed unique and delicious twists that rival even the age-old recipes of Germany.

NUREMBERG

Bratwurst Herzle inexpensive

Brunnengasse 11; www.bratwurstherzle.de

This old-fashioned and down-to-earth little place, tucked away in a central old town alley, has served the perfect Nuremberg mini-sausages and sauerkraut since 1529. It's always so busy that most diners have to share a table.

Nassauer Keller inexpensive

Karolinenstrasse 2; +49 911 225 967

Worth visiting for the atmospheric medieval cellar dining experience alone, this restaurant is based in one of the only surviving medieval tower houses. It specializes in Franconian cuisine, such as *Schweineschäufele* (roast pork shoulder) and serves several types of sausages, including "original Nuremberg sausages."

Bratwurst-Häusle moderate

Rathausplatz 1, 90403; +49 911 227 695

This tiny historic restaurant in the shadows of St. Sebald church is so well known and touristy that it's often too packed for its own good. Yet it remains a great place to pick up bratwurst to go along with jars of cured or smoked sausages.

Bratwurstglöcklein expensive

Waffenhof 5; +49 911 227 625

This is the oldest bratwurst restaurant in Nuremberg, dating back to 1313, and its half-dozen set menus strive to create an interesting Franconian meal. They include dishes such as dumpling soup, pork knuckle, Nuremberg sausages that have been simmered with onions and vinegar before grilling, wine sauerkraut, homemade potato salad with a creamy horseradish sauce, and *O'batzder*, a rich local cheese dip made with Camembert and served with pretzels.

ERFURT, GERMANY

The German state of Thuringia also claims to have invented bratwurst. The city is certainly sausage-mad: every adult here consumes an average of two 6–7 inch (15–20 cm) bratwürsts every day, and Thuringian sausage has become the German standard.

Faustfood inexpensive

Waagegasse 1; www.faustfood.de

A minimalist grilled meat and sausage eatery with modern interiors; you can sit at chunky wooden tables or perch at the busy counter to enjoy a quick barbecued *Thüringer Rostbratwurst*.

Wirtshaus Christoffel inexpensive

Michaelisstrasse 41; +49 361 2626 943

This medieval-themed restaurant has been serving its specialty sausage with bread and broth continuously since 1477.

Zum Wenigemarkt moderate

Wenigemarkt 13; www.wenigemarkt-13.de

Popular for alfresco eating in summer, this cozy restaurant excels at traditional Thuringian cuisine. It serves an especially crispy *Rostbratwurst* with fried potatoes and sauerkraut laced with bacon flakes.

BERLIN, GERMANY

A city that is always on the go is reliant on a good supply of snacks, and in Berlin this means sausages, especially "currywurst" – chopped sausage smothered in tomato sauce mixed with curry powder.

Curry 195 inexpensive

Kurfürstendamm 195, Berlin; +49 030 881 8942

A neon-lit sausage eatery known as much for its excellent, juicy currywurst sausages as its popularity with German celebrities – which explains the Champagne on the menu.

Konnopke's Imbiss inexpensive

Schönhauser Allee 44a; www.konnopke-imbiss.de

Berlin's most famous sausage kiosk sits beneath noisy elevated train tracks. It has survived the Nazis, World War II, and the privations of East Germany to continue to dole out some of the city's best currywurst: marvelously juicy, served with crispy fries and sprinkled with paprika.

